

Chase DeLauter

24.5 years old
PPI Pick Eligible

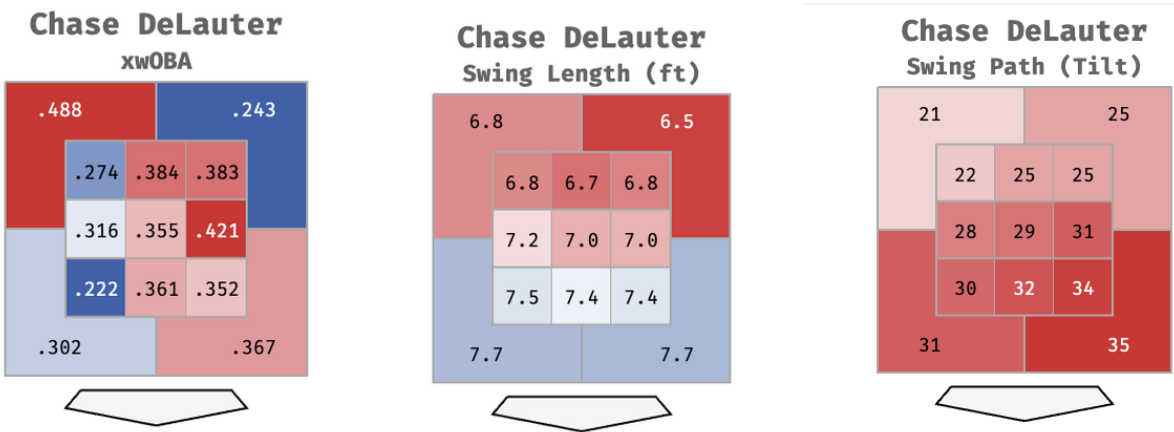
#24
Bats: Left
Throws: Left

G	AVG/OBP/SLG	HR	RBI	SB	BsR	wRC+	DRS	fWAR
120	.294/.365/.458	13	60	10	0.1	133	1	3.1

EARLY PRODUCTION AND MIDSEASON TURNAROUND

Chase DeLauter has been hit with the injury bug in 2026 to interrupt his elite production. DeLauter got off to a great start in March and April, slashing .257/.345/.485 with a 132 wRC+ and a .373 xwOBA. DeLauter’s production slowed in May before he landed in the IL with a rib cage contusion on June 17. From May 1st to June 17th, DeLauter had a wRC+ of 96 and an xwOBA of .321. DeLauter returned from injury producing at an even higher level. Since returning from injury on June 28th, DeLauter is slashing .332/.397/.517, accounting for a 158 wRC+ and an xwOBA of .342.

ZONE STRENGTHS AND WEAKNESSES



DeLauter’s xwOBA, swing length and swing-path tilt by zone

DeLauter has the highest xwOBA across the 6 zones of the inner half, which aligns with his differences in swing length and swing path. His zone xwOBA also displays the potential holes in his swing, with drop-offs on pitches away in all 3 vertical quadrants. With DeLauter's ability to shorten his swing on pitches in the zone, he could look to get closer to the plate to better protect against away pitches that currently give him issues.

THE SCISSOR KICK AND ZONE SPECIFIC SWING CHANGES

DeLauter can fire his hands and alter his swing depending on the location of the pitch to induce better results. On pitches up and in, DeLauter shortens his swing by nearly a foot compared to down and in. DeLauter’s flatter bat path allows him to barrel these pitches more consistently, which is especially important given how pitchers use velocity up in the zone in today’s game. When he sees pitches down and in, which often are offspeed pitches, DeLauter deploys a longer swing, but with above-average tilt, to get more backspin on the ball to the pull side.

His offensive upside allows him to develop into a power-first corner bat for the Guardians. The biggest developmental question will be how he adjusts to the holes pitchers may target, particularly on the outer half of the zone, where his different swing shapes and results have shown greater vulnerability. DeLauter is a bat-first prospect, but he has displayed slightly above-average defensive ability in right field. He does not currently profile as a strong long-term center-field option, making a corner-outfield role the more likely defensive fit.